1. Basic facts

Full name and other names

- **Birth name:** Subhas Chandra Bose (also spelled Subhash Chandra Bose) | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "Subhas Chandra Bose (born January 23, 1897, Cuttack, Orissa [now Odisha], India..."
- **Honorific title ("Netaji"):** Indian soldiers and officials in Berlin began calling him "Netaji" ("Respected Leader") in early 1942 | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "The honorific Netaji (Hindustani for "Respected Leader") was first applied to Bose in Germany in early 1942"
- **1941 escape alias in India and Afghanistan:** Used the name Muhammad Ziauddin, posing as an Afghan insurance agent | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "Bose escaped his residence in Calcutta disguised as an Afghan named Muhammad Ziauddin."
- **1941 passport alias to Moscow and Berlin:** Traveled on an Italian passport under the name Count Orlando Mazzotta | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "travelled to Moscow on the Italian passport of an Italian nobleman "Count Orlando Mazzotta"."

Born (date, place) / Died (date, place, how)

- **Birth:** Born on 23 January 1897 in Cuttack, Odisha (then part of the Bengal Presidency) | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "born to Bengali parents Prabhabati Bose (née Dutt) and Janakinath Bose on 23 January 1897 in Cuttack"
- **Death (official and majority inquiry finding):** Died on 18 August 1945 in a Japanese military hospital in Taihoku (now Taipei, Taiwan) from burns after a plane crash | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "died in a Japanese hospital in Taiwan from burn injuries on August 18, 1945, as a result of a plane crash"
- **Death (disputed 2005 inquiry finding):** The 2005 Mukherjee Commission concluded he did not die in the Taipei plane crash, a finding rejected by the Indian government (see Section 4) | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "the Justice Mukherjee Commission of Inquiry concluded in 2005 that, although Bose is dead, he did not die in a plane crash"

Family, education, work

- **Parents and siblings:** Ninth of 14 children born to lawyer Janakinath Bose and Prabhabati Bose | National Library Board Singapore | > "Bose was the ninth child of a family of 14 and the sixth son of Janakinath Bose, a lawyer"
- **Brother and supporter:** His older brother Sarat Chandra Bose, a lawyer and Congress politician, supported him financially | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "Bose was supported financially throughout his career by his elder brother Sarat Chandra Bose"
- **Marriage and child:** Met Emilie Schenkl in Vienna in 1934, married her in 1937 (see Section 4 on marriage records), and had a daughter, Anita, in 1942 | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "While in Vienna in 1934 Bose met Emilie Schenkl, who became his secretary. They married in 1937 and had a daughter, Anita, in 1942."
- **Schooling in Cuttack:** Attended the Protestant European School from 1902 and Ravenshaw Collegiate School from 1909 | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose entered the Baptist Mission's Protestant European School in Cuttack in January 1902."

and > "In 1909, the 12-year-old Subhas Bose followed his five brothers to the Ravenshaw Collegiate School"

- **Colleges in Calcutta:** Entered Presidency College in 1913, was expelled in 1916, and completed his philosophy B.A. at Scottish Church College (sources give 1918 or 1919; see Section 4) | South Asian Britain | > "In 1916 Bose was expelled for his complicity in beating a college tutor, Professor Oaten... He joined Scottish Church College"
- **University of Cambridge and ICS exam:** Studied at Fitzwilliam Hall, Cambridge, placed fourth in the 1920 Indian Civil Service exam, and resigned in April 1921 | South Asian Britain | > "In July 1920 Bose took the ICS exams in London and came fourth... Finally, in April 1921, Bose withdrew"
- **Newspaper and city government work:** Started the newspaper *Swaraj* (1922), edited *Forward* (1923), served as CEO of the Calcutta Municipal Corporation (1924), and became Mayor of Calcutta (1930) | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "In 1922 Bose founded the newspaper Swaraj" and > "Bose worked as the CEO of the Calcutta Municipal Corporation for Das when the latter was elected mayor of Calcutta in 1924."

Groups and organisations they belonged to

- **Cambridge Majlis:** Student society at Cambridge | South Asian Britain | > "He attended the Cambridge Union Society debates and was a member of the Cambridge Majlis."
- **Indian National Congress (INC):** Member from 1921, General Secretary in 1927, and President in 1938 and 1939 | The Tribune | > "twice elected Congress President, at Haripura (1938) and Tripuri (1939)."
- **Bengal Volunteers / Congress Volunteer Corps:** Organised and commanded uniformed Congress youth volunteers in Bengal | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "Under his leadership, the Congress youth group in Bengal was organised into a quasi-military organisation called the Bengal Volunteers."
- **All India Forward Bloc:** Political faction within Congress founded by Bose in 1939 | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "On 22 June 1939 Bose organised the All India Forward Bloc a faction within the Indian National Congress"
- **Free India Centre, Azad Hind Radio, and Free India Legion (Indian Legion):** Established in Berlin between 1941 and 1942 with German funding and Indian prisoners of war | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "There he sought to raise an army of Indian soldiers from prisoners of war captured by Germany, forming the Free India Legion and the Azad Hind Radio."
- **Indian Independence League (IIL) and Indian National Army (INA / Azad Hind Fauj):** Took leadership of both in Singapore in July 1943 | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "On 4 July 1943 two days after reaching Singapore, Bose assumed the leadership of the IIL and the Second Indian National Army"
- **Provisional Government of Free India (Azad Hind):** Formed in Singapore on 21 October 1943 with Bose as head of state | The Tribune | > "In Japanese-occupied Singapore, Subhas Chandra Bose proclaimed the Provisional Government of Free India (Azad Hind) on 21 October 1943."

The 10 most important events in his life (in date order)

1. **Expulsion from Presidency College (February 1916):** Expelled after students beat Professor E. F. Oaten with sandals on a college staircase | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "on 15 February, some students accosted Oaten on a stairway, surrounded him, beat him with sandals... Bose was expelled from the college"
2. **Resignation from the Indian Civil Service (22 April 1921):** Gave up his ICS appointment in England to return to India's independence movement | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "On 22 April 1921, he wrote to the Secretary of State for India, Edwin Montagu, stating, "I wish to have my name removed from the list of probationers""
3. **First arrest in Calcutta (December 1921):** Arrested with Chittaranjan Das after organising a boycott of the Prince of Wales's visit | National Library Board Singapore | > "Bose and Das were arrested on Christmas day in 1921 for successfully organising a boycott against the Prince of Wales's visit to India"
4. **Imprisonment in Mandalay, Burma (1924–1927):** Arrested in October 1924 while serving as Calcutta's municipal CEO and held in Mandalay prison, where he developed tuberculosis | National Library Board Singapore | > "Bose was again detained in Mandalay, under the new Bengal Ordinance on 24 October 1924. He was released only two-and-a-half years later"
5. **Congress Presidency and resignation (1938–1939):** Elected Congress President in 1938 and 1939, then resigned over disagreements with Mahatma Gandhi's wing and formed the Forward Bloc | The Tribune | > "Differences with Gandhi over strategy pushed him to resign in 1939 and found the Forward Bloc."
6. **Hunger strike in prison (1940):** Arrested in July 1940 after protesting the Holwell Monument in Calcutta and released after going on a hunger strike | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "in July 1940 he was again incarcerated. His refusal to remain in prison at this critical period of India's history was expressed in a determination to fast to death"
7. **Escape from Calcutta to Berlin (January–April 1941):** Sneaked out of his guarded Calcutta house in disguise and traveled overland via Kabul and Moscow to Berlin | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "He escaped in disguise and made his way through Afghanistan and Central -Asia. He came first to the Soviet Union and then to Germany, reaching Berlin on 2 April 1941."
8. **Submarine voyage from Germany to Asia (February–May 1943):** Traveled for three months in a German U-boat and a Japanese submarine, transferring at sea near Madagascar to reach Sumatra and Tokyo | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose boarded a German submarine in February 1943. Off Madagascar, he was transferred to a Japanese submarine from which he disembarked in Japanese-held Sumatra in May 1943."
9. **Leading the INA and Azad Hind Government (1943–1945):** Assumed command of the INA in July 1943, proclaimed the Azad Hind government in October 1943, and joined the 1944 Imphal-Kohima campaign into Manipur | The Tribune | > "took command of the Indian National Army in 1943, and headed the Azad Hind... The INA fought alongside Japanese forces in the 1944 Imphal-Kohima campaign"
10. **Taihoku plane crash (18 August 1945):** While flying toward Manchuria after Japan's surrender, his Japanese bomber crashed at Taihoku (Taipei), causing fatal burns

according to official records | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose died from third-degree burns after his plane crashed in Taiwan (then under Japanese occupation) on 18 August 1945." (from Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose)

2. Story angles (at least 10)

Angle 1: Running Away at Age 17 to Search for a Guru

- **Title:** The Boy Who Ran Away to Find a Holy Teacher
- **One-line hook:** At age 17, Subhas secretly left college without telling his parents to search northern India for a spiritual teacher, only to return home sick with typhoid fever.
- **Key facts:**
  - During his 1914 college vacation, Bose and his friend Hemanta Kumar Sarkar traveled across northern India looking for a guru without clearly informing his parents | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "In the long vacations of 1914, they traveled to northern India for several months to search for a spiritual guru to guide them."
  - He visited holy cities across northern India but found no teacher he wanted to follow | National Library Board Singapore | > "After visiting renowned gurus of his day in places such as Rishikesh, Hardwar, Mathura, Brindavan, Varanasi and Gaya, he failed to find a guru"
  - He caught typhoid fever during the trip, and his worried parents broke down when he got home | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "During the trip, in which the guru proved elusive, Subhas came down with typhoid fever."

Angle 2: The Sandal Incident on the Presidency College Stairs

- **Title:** Trouble on the College Staircase
- **One-line hook:** When students at Presidency College beat a British professor with sandals on a stairway, a college servant spotted 19-year-old Subhas running away—and the university expelled him.
- **Key facts:**
  - Students accused Professor E. F. Oaten of making rude remarks about Indian culture and pushing students, while Oaten said they were making noise outside his classroom | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Oaten had made rude remarks about Indian culture, and collared and pushed some students; according to Oaten, the students were making an unacceptably loud noise"
  - On 15 February 1916, students surrounded Oaten on a staircase and struck him with sandals | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "on 15 February, some students accosted Oaten on a stairway, surrounded him, beat him with sandals, and took to flight."
  - A college servant testified to seeing Bose fleeing the scene, and Calcutta University expelled him until July 1917 | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "a college servant testified to seeing Subhas Bose among those fleeing... Bose was expelled from the college and rusticated from the University of Calcutta."

Angle 3: Turning Down a Top Job in the British Government

- **Title:** "Chained to the Civil Service"
- **One-line hook:** Subhas went to England and won one of only six spots in the top British

government exam—then quit because he refused to work for the people ruling his country.

- **Key facts:**
  - Competing for six openings in the Indian Civil Service (ICS) in August 1920, Bose finished fourth | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "There were six vacancies in the ICS. Subhas Bose took the open competitive exam for them in August 1920 and was placed fourth."
  - He wrote to his brother Sarat that staying in the British service meant he could not serve India | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "it is not possible to serve one's country in the best and fullest manner if one is chained on to the civil service."
  - On 22 April 1921, he wrote to Edwin Montagu asking to be taken off the list of civil servants | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "On 22 April 1921, he wrote to the Secretary of State for India, Edwin Montagu, stating, "I wish to have my name removed from the list of probationers""
  - His mother wrote him a letter backing his decision | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "I received a letter from mother saying that in spite of what father and others think she prefers the ideals for which Mahatma Gandhi stands."

Angle 4: The Tailored General's Uniform and the Misdelivered Telegram

- **Title:** The General's Telegram That Went to the Wrong Fort
- **One-line hook:** In 1928, Subhas ordered a general's uniform from British tailors in Calcutta to lead Congress volunteers—and the post office accidentally delivered his telegram to the real British general at Fort William.
- **Key facts:**
  - At the December 1928 Calcutta Congress session, Bose commanded the uniformed Congress Volunteer Corps with the title "General Officer Commanding" (GOC) | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "In late December 1928, Bose organised the Annual Meeting of the Indian National Congress in Calcutta. His most memorable role was as general officer commanding (GOC) Congress Volunteer Corps."
  - According to writer Nirad Chaudhuri (LATER MEMORY / ACCOUNT by Nirad Chaudhuri), British tailors Harman's made Bose's uniform, and a telegram addressed to "GOC" was delivered to the British general at Fort William | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "his uniform was made by a firm of British tailors in Calcutta, Harman's. A telegram addressed to him as GOC was delivered to the British General in Fort William"
  - According to Chaudhuri, Mahatma Gandhi disliked the marching and boots and called the session a circus | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Mahatma Gandhi as a sincere pacifist vowed to non-violence, did not like the strutting, clicking of boots, and saluting, and he afterward described the Calcutta session of the Congress as a Bertram Mills circus"

Angle 5: The Midnight Escape in the Wanderer Car and the Deaf-and-Mute Disguise

- **Title:** The Midnight Disguise of Muhammad Ziauddin
- **One-line hook:** Watched by secret police in Calcutta, Subhas grew a beard behind

closed curtains, slipped out at night in his nephew's car wearing a fez, and pretended to be deaf and mute across the frontier into Afghanistan.

- **Key facts:**
  - In January 1941, while his Elgin Road house in Calcutta was watched by the CID, Bose stayed out of sight for several days to grow a beard and dressed in Pathan clothes | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "A few days before his escape, he sought solitude and, on this pretext, avoided meeting British guards and grew a beard... he dressed as a Pathan (brown long coat, a black fez-type hat and broad pyjamas)"
  - His nephew Sisir Kumar Bose drove him out at night in a Wanderer W24 sedan to Gomoh Railway Station | Wikimedia Commons: File:Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's Car's Front View.jpg | > "Wanderer W24 Sedan car, on display at "Netaji Bhawan" (his ancestral house turned museum) which was used by him for his "Great escape" from house arrest in Calcutta"
  - Because Bose could not speak Pashto, Mian Akbar Shah advised him to pretend he was deaf and mute while crossing the frontier with guide Bhagat Ram Talwar (who was secretly a Soviet agent) | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Since Bose could not speak Pashto, it would have made him an easy target... Shah suggested that Bose act deaf and dumb... Bose's guide Bhagat Ram Talwar, unknown to him, was a Soviet agent."

Angle 6: Three Months Underwater and the Atlantic Near-Collision

- **Title:** Ninety Days Under the Sea
- **One-line hook:** To travel from Germany to Asia in 1943, Subhas spent three months inside two submarines, diving underwater by day and once escaping an enemy ship by just a few yards.
- **Key facts:**
  - Between February and May 1943, Bose and his secretary Major Abid Hassan traveled from Europe to Sumatra using one German submarine and one Japanese submarine, switching boats off Madagascar | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose boarded a German submarine in February 1943. Off Madagascar, he was transferred to a Japanese submarine from which he disembarked in Japanese-held Sumatra in May 1943."
  - According to Major Abid Hassan (EYEWITNESS MEMORY told at an April 1946 Calcutta press conference), the submarines stayed submerged all day and traveled only at night | Hindustan Times | > "the long time taken for the journey was due to the fact that we had to remain submerged throughout the day and could only travel at night"
  - In the Atlantic Ocean, an enemy ship spotted their submarine on the surface and sped toward them to ram it before they dived with yards to spare | Hindustan Times | > "It came full speed towards our submarine with a view to ramming it... when the enemy was a few yards away we submerged and thus escaped disaster."

Angle 7: Teenage Rubber-Estate Volunteers and the Doctor Who Led Them

- **Title:** The Doctor and the Teenage Soldiers of the Rani of Jhansi Regiment
- **One-line hook:** Hundreds of teenage Indian girls working on rubber plantations in Malaya—most of whom had never even seen India—joined a Singapore doctor to train

with rifles and bayonets.

- **Key facts:**
  - On 12 July 1943, Bose announced the formation of the all-female Rani of Jhansi Regiment, named after Rani Lakshmi Bai of the 1857 rebellion | Wikipedia: Rani of Jhansi Regiment | > "Bose announced the formation of the Regiment on 12 July 1943. Most of the women were teenage volunteers of Indian descent from Malayan rubber estates; very few had ever been to India."
  - The regiment was commanded by Captain Dr. Lakshmi Swaminathan (later Lakshmi Sahgal), a doctor in Singapore | Wikipedia: Azad Hind | > "Lakshmi was one of the most popular and prosperous gynaecologists in Singapore before she gave up her practice to lead the troops of the Rani of Jhansi Regiment."
  - Starting on 23 October 1943 in Singapore, cadets trained in route marches, rifles, hand grenades, bayonet charges, and nursing | Wikipedia: Rani of Jhansi Regiment | > "Training in Singapore began on 23 October 1943... These cadets underwent military and combat training with drills, route marches as well as weapons training in rifles, hand grenades, and bayonet charges."

Angle 8: The Unissued Postage Stamps and One-Sided Banknotes of Azad Hind

- **Title:** Stamps and Money for a Country That Was Still Under British Rule
- **One-line hook:** Before his army even crossed into India, Subhas had German artists print a million postage stamps showing broken chains and opened a bank in Rangoon that printed its own paper money on one side.
- **Key facts:**
  - In early 1943 in Berlin, Bose commissioned ten designs of "Azad Hind" postage stamps printed at the German government printing bureau (Reichsdruckerei), though they were never issued for mail | Wikipedia: Azad Hind stamps | > "The Azad Hind stamps are a set of prepared but never issued stamps for the planned Provisional Government of Free India... The stamps were commissioned by Bose himself during his stay in Berlin in early 1943."
  - The stamp designs included an Indian woman at a spinning wheel, broken chains and daggers over a map of India, and three soldiers holding the flag of Free India | Wikipedia: Azad Hind stamps | > "Broken chain and daggers in front of a map of British India" and > "Three Indian soldiers flying the flag of "Free India", framed by two daggers."
  - On 5 April 1944, Bose established the Azad Hind Bank in Rangoon to hold donations from overseas Indians and issued promissory currency notes printed on one side | Wikipedia: Azad Hind Bank | > "Azad Hind Bank was established on 5 April 1944, at Rangoon... The currency notes were issued in the form of Promissory note, and these notes were usually printed on one side."

Angle 9: Walking 80 Miles Along the Sittang River Under Air Attack

- **Title:** The Eighty-Mile Walk to Moulmein
- **One-line hook:** When American planes bombed their trucks at a river in Burma in April 1945, Subhas refused a ride for himself and walked 80 miles through the heat alongside

his retreating men and women soldiers.

- **Key facts:**
  - In late April 1945, Bose left Rangoon with several hundred INA soldiers and nearly a hundred women from the Rani of Jhansi Regiment | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "During the last week of April 1945, Subhas Chandra Bose along with his senior Indian National Army (INA) officers, several hundred enlisted INA men, and nearly a hundred women from the INA's Rani of Jhansi Regiment left Rangoon"
  - When American plane attacks stopped their vehicles at the Sittang River, Bose refused separate transport and walked 80 miles on foot to Moulmein | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "very few vehicles were able to cross the river because of American strafing runs. Bose and his party walked the remaining 80 miles (130 km) to Moulmein over the next week."
  - He refused to leave his troops even when Japanese soldiers offered him transport | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "Bose walked with his troops, refusing to leave them despite Japanese soldiers finding him transport."

Angle 10: The 45 "Tokyo Boys" Sent to Train as Fighter Pilots

- **Title:** The Forty-Five "Tokyo Boys"
- **One-line hook:** Subhas personally picked 45 young Indian recruits—nicknamed the "Tokyo Boys"—and sent them to Japan's military academy to learn how to fly fighter planes.
- **Key facts:**
  - Bose created a youth wing of 45 young Indians whom he personally selected to train as fighter pilots in Japan | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "A youth wing of the INA, composed of 45 young Indians personally chosen by Bose and known as the Tokyo Boys, was also sent to Japan's Imperial Military Academy, where its members trained as fighter pilots."

Angle 11: What Happened After—The Red Fort Trials of Three Officers from Three Religions

- **Title:** Three Friends on Trial at the Red Fort
- **One-line hook:** After the war, the British put three of Subhas's officers—a Hindu, a Muslim, and a Sikh—on trial together at Delhi's Red Fort, accidentally uniting Indians across the country in massive protests.
- **Key facts:**
  - Between November 1945 and May 1946, British authorities held public courts-martial of INA officers at the Red Fort in Delhi | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "Between November 1945 and May 1946, approximately ten courts-martial were held in public at the Red Fort in Delhi."
  - The first joint trial charged Prem Sahgal, Gurubaksh Singh Dhillon, and Shah Nawaz Khan—belonging to Hinduism, Sikhism, and Islam | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "the first and most celebrated joint courts-martial – those of Prem Sahgal, Gurubaksh Singh Dhillon and Shah Nawaz Khan... The three accused were from the three major religions of India: Hinduism, Islam, and Sikhism."

- Instead of turning public opinion against the INA, the Red Fort trials sparked nationwide protests and mutinies that pressured British rule | The Tribune | > "The public trials of INA officers at the Red Fort in 1945-46 turned Bose's army into a nationwide symbol of defiance, feeding the unrest, including the 1946 naval mutiny"

Which angle is the big "flagship" story, and why

Angle 5 (The Midnight Disguise of Muhammad Ziauddin) combined with **Angle 6 (Ninety Days Under the Sea)** is the strongest flagship story for 10-year-old readers. It has concrete physical objects still visible today (the Wanderer W24 car in Kolkata), clear suspense (secret police outside the house, growing a beard behind closed doors, pretending to be deaf and mute across mountain checkpoints, and switching between two submarines in the middle of the ocean), and explains how Bose moved from house arrest in India to leading an army in Southeast Asia.

3. People and places connected

People

- **Janakinath Bose:** Subhas Chandra Bose's father, a lawyer and government pleader in Cuttack.
- **Prabhabati Bose (née Dutt):** Subhas Chandra Bose's mother, who wrote to support his decision to reject the British civil service in 1921.
- **Sarat Chandra Bose:** Subhas's older brother, a Calcutta lawyer and Congress politician who supported him financially throughout his life.
- **Hemanta Kumar Sarkar:** College friend who traveled with 17-year-old Subhas across northern India in 1914 looking for a spiritual guru.
- **E. F. Oaten:** British history professor at Presidency College whose 1916 assault by students led to Bose's expulsion.
- **Edwin Montagu:** British Secretary of State for India, to whom Bose sent his Indian Civil Service resignation letter on 22 April 1921.
- **Chittaranjan Das (C. R. Das):** Bengal Congress politician, Mayor of Calcutta, and Bose's political mentor in the early 1920s.
- **Mahatma Gandhi (Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi):** Leader of the Indian National Congress whose commitment to non-violence clashed with Bose's push for armed resistance.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru:** Congress leader who served alongside Bose as General Secretary in 1927 and later became India's first Prime Minister.
- **Pattabhi Sitaramayya:** Congress politician backed by Gandhi whom Bose defeated in the 1939 Congress presidential election at Tripuri.
- **Emilie Schenkl:** Austrian woman whom Bose met in Vienna in 1934, married in 1937, and with whom he had a daughter, Anita, in 1942.
- **Anita Bose Pfaff:** Daughter of Subhas Chandra Bose and Emilie Schenkl, born in Vienna on 29 November 1942.
- **Sisir Kumar Bose:** Subhas's nephew, who drove him at night from his guarded Calcutta house to Gomoh Railway Station in January 1941.

- **Mian Akbar Shah:** Forward Bloc leader in the North-West Frontier Province who suggested Bose pretend to be deaf and mute during his 1941 escape.
- **Bhagat Ram Talwar:** Guide who led Bose across the frontier into Afghanistan in 1941 while secretly working as a Soviet agent.
- **Major Abid Hassan (Abid Hasan):** Bose's personal secretary who accompanied him on the three-month submarine voyage from Germany to Sumatra in 1943.
- **Rash Behari Bose:** Indian revolutionary living in Japan who founded the Indian Independence League and handed leadership of the movement in East Asia to Subhas Chandra Bose in July 1943.
- **General Mohan Singh:** British Indian Army officer captured in Malaya who founded the First Indian National Army in 1942 before its dissolution.
- **Captain Dr. Lakshmi Swaminathan (Lakshmi Sahgal):** Singapore doctor who gave up her medical practice to command the all-women Rani of Jhansi Regiment and serve as Minister of Women's Organization in Azad Hind.
- **Colonel Habibur Rahman (Habib ur Rahman):** INA officer and deputy chief of staff who accompanied Bose on his final flight on 18 August 1945 and survived the crash with severe burns.
- **Dr. Taneyoshi Yoshimi:** Chief surgeon at Nanmon Military Hospital in Taihoku who treated Bose for third-degree burns on 18 August 1945.
- **Prem Sahgal, Gurubaksh Singh Dhillon, and Shah Nawaz Khan:** Senior INA officers tried together for treason by the British at the Red Fort in 1945–1946; Shah Nawaz Khan later chaired the 1956 inquiry into Bose's death.

Groups and Events

- **Indian Civil Service (ICS):** The elite administrative service of British India, for which Bose placed fourth in 1920 before resigning in 1921.
- **All India Forward Bloc:** Left-wing political group within Congress founded by Bose on 22 June 1939 after resigning as Congress President.
- **Free India Legion (Indian Legion):** Force of 3,000 to 4,500 Indian prisoners of war in Germany recruited by Bose between 1941 and 1943.
- **Indian National Army (INA / Azad Hind Fauj):** Armed force of Indian prisoners of war and civilian volunteers in Southeast Asia led by Bose from July 1943 to August 1945.
- **Provisional Government of Free India (Azad Hind):** Government-in-exile proclaimed by Bose in Singapore on 21 October 1943.
- **Rani of Jhansi Regiment:** The all-female combat and nursing regiment of the INA established in July 1943.
- **Red Fort Trials (INA Trials):** Public courts-martial of INA officers in Delhi in 1945–1946 that sparked mass protests across India.

Places

- **Cuttack, Odisha:** Town where Bose was born on 23 January 1897 and attended school until 1913.
- **Presidency College & Scottish Church College, Calcutta (Kolkata):** Colleges where Bose studied philosophy; he was expelled from Presidency in 1916 and graduated from

Scottish Church College.
- **Fitzwilliam Hall, University of Cambridge:** Non-collegiate institution in England where Bose studied from 1919 to 1921.
- **Mandalay Prison, Burma (Myanmar):** Prison where British authorities held Bose from 1924 to 1927.
- **38/2 Elgin Road (Netaji Bhawan), Calcutta:** Bose family house from which Subhas escaped British surveillance in January 1941.
- **Gomoh Railway Station (now Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Gomoh Station), Jharkhand:** Train station where Sisir Kumar Bose dropped Subhas off during his January 1941 escape.
- **Cathay Cinema Hall / Building, Singapore:** Venue where Bose assumed leadership of the INA in July 1943 and proclaimed the Provisional Government of Free India on 21 October 1943.
- **Andaman and Nicobar Islands:** Islands captured by Japan and nominally handed over to Bose's Azad Hind government in late 1943, which renamed them "Shaheed" and "Swaraj".
- **Moirang, Imphal, and Kohima (Manipur and Nagaland):** Towns in northeastern India where the INA and Japanese forces fought British forces in 1944; the INA raised the tricolour flag at Moirang.
- **Taihoku Airfield (now Songshan Airport, Taipei, Taiwan) & Nanmon Military Hospital:** Site of the 18 August 1945 bomber crash and the hospital where Bose was treated.
- **Renkō-ji Temple, Tokyo, Japan:** Nichiren Buddhist temple in Tokyo where ashes reported to be Bose's have been kept since September 1945.

4. Disputes, legends and doubts

1. How and when Subhas Chandra Bose died (18 August 1945 Taihoku plane crash vs. staged escape theories)

- **Official British, Japanese, and two Indian Government Inquiry findings (Died on 18 August 1945 in Taipei):**
  - **1946 Figgess Report (British Indian Political Intelligence):** Confirmed Bose died of burns and shock at Taihoku Military Hospital on 18 August 1945 | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "it is confirmed as certain that S.C. Bose died in a Taihoku Military Hospital (Nammon Ward) sometime between 1700 hours and 2000 hours local time on the August 18, 1945."
  - **1956 Government of Japan Report (declassified September 2016):** Concluded that a propeller blade broke after takeoff in Taiwan on 18 August 1945 and Bose died of burns hours later | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "An investigative report by the Government of Japan titled "Investigation on the cause of death and other matters of the late Subhas Chandra Bose" was declassified on 1 September 2016. It concluded that Bose died in a plane crash"
  - **1956 Shah Nawaz Committee & 1970–1974 Justice G. D. Khosla Commission (Government of India):** Both official Indian inquiries interviewed crash survivors and hospital staff and concluded Bose died in the Taipei crash and his ashes are at Renkō-ji

Temple | National Library Board Singapore | > "The Shah Nawaz Khan Committee (1956) and the Justice G. D. Khosla Commission (1970–74) both concluded that Bose had died in the air crash in Taipei."

- **Dissenting family report and the 2005 Mukherjee Commission (Did not die in the plane crash):**
  - **FAMILY DISSENT (1956) — Suresh Chandra Bose:** Subhas's elder brother Suresh Chandra Bose served on the 1956 Shah Nawaz Committee, refused to sign the final report, and wrote a minority report claiming there was no crash and his brother was alive | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose's brother, Suresh Chandra Bose, however, after having signed off on the initial conclusions, declined to sign the final report... Using this principle, Bose is able to ... find that there was no crash and that his brother lives."
  - **2005 Justice M. K. Mukherjee Commission of Inquiry:** Concluded in November 2005 that the plane crash was a cover story to let Bose reach the Soviet Union and that the ashes at Renkō-ji Temple belonged to a Japanese soldier named Ichiro Okura; the Government of India rejected the commission's findings in May 2006 | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "the commission concluded that those accounts could not be relied upon and that there was a secret plan to ensure Bose's safe passage to the USSR... The Indian Government rejected the findings of the commission."
  - **LATER MEMORY (1946) — Major Abid Hassan:** In April 1946, Bose's former secretary Major Abid Hassan told reporters he believed Bose was still alive because no body was seen by aides left behind in Saigon | Hindustan Times | > "Major Hussain strongly believed that Netaji was alive. The hand of God, he said, had been protecting Netaji till now"
  - **FAMILY MEMORY / STATEMENT (2024) — Chandra Kumar Bose & Anita Bose Pfaff:** Bose's grandnephew Chandra Kumar Bose stated in 2024 that neither Sarat Chandra Bose nor Emilie Schenkl ever had definite proof of Subhas being alive after 18 August 1945 | The Hindu | > ""“Close family members including beloved brother Sarat Chandra Bose under British detention in south India and widow Emilie in Vienna, continued to yearn for Subhas's return; but neither at any time had any definite knowledge of Subhas being alive after 18 August 1945,”"

2. Legends of Bose living in disguise as a holy man ("Sadhu of Shaulmari" and "Gumnami Baba")

- **LEGEND (1960s) — The Sadhu of Shaulmari Ashram (promoted by "Subhasbadi Janata"):** In the early 1960s, a group of former associates called the "Subhasbadi Janata" claimed Bose had returned to India as a Hindu holy man named Srimat Saradanandaji at Shaulmari in North Bengal; the sadhu himself denied being Bose and died in 1977 | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Some associates of Bose, from two decades before, had formed an organization, the "Subhasbadi Janata", to promote this story in which Bose was now the chief sadhu of an ashram (or hermitage) in Shaulmari... The chief sadhu himself vigorously denied being Bose."
- **LEGEND (1980s–2000s) — "Gumnami Baba" / "Bhagwanji" of Faizabad:** Followers claimed a recluse known as "Gumnami Baba" (or "Bhagwanji") in Faizabad, Uttar Pradesh,

was Subhas Chandra Bose; the Mukherjee Commission tested DNA samples and concluded Gumnami Baba was not Bose | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "It also determined Gumnami Baba to be different from Subhas Bose in light of a DNA profiling test."

3. Exact time of death on 18 August 1945

- **Version A (Between 17:00 and 20:00 local time):** The 1946 Figgess Report placed Bose's death between 5:00 pm and 8:00 pm | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "S.C. Bose died in a Taihoku Military Hospital (Nammon Ward) sometime between 1700 hours and 2000 hours local time on the August 18, 1945."
- **Version B (Between 9:00 pm and 10:00 pm Taihoku time):** Historian Leonard A. Gordon's interviews with hospital staff placed his death between 9:00 pm and 10:00 pm | Wikipedia: Death of Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Bose went into a coma and died between 9 pm and 10 pm Taihoku time."
- **Version C (11:50 pm):** Singapore's National Library Board notes an account in which Dr. Yoshimi recalled Bose dying at 11:50 pm | National Library Board Singapore | > "Yoshimi recalled that Bose was burnt from head to toe when he was admitted to the hospital and passed away later, at 11.50 pm."

4. Exact date Bose escaped from his Calcutta house in January 1941

- **Version A (Night of 16–17 January 1941):** Wikipedia's biography and the Netaji Bhawan museum car description place the escape from his Elgin Road house on the night of 16–17 January 1941, with 26 January 1941 as the date he crossed toward the Afghan frontier | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "Late night 16 January 1941, the night of his escape, he dressed as a Pathan... Bose escaped from under British surveillance from his Elgin Road house in Calcutta on the night of 17 January 1941"
- **Version B (26 January 1941):** *Encyclopædia Britannica* states that he escaped his Calcutta residence on 26 January 1941 | Encyclopædia Britannica | > "On January 26, 1941, despite close surveillance, Bose escaped his residence in Calcutta disguised as an Afghan named Muhammad Ziauddin."

5. Graduation year from Scottish Church College (1918 vs. 1919) and arrival date in Britain (September vs. October 1919)

- **Version A (B.A. in 1918; arrived in London 20 October 1919):** Wikipedia states Bose received his B.A. in 1918 and arrived in London on 20 October 1919 | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "He joined Scottish Church College, receiving his B.A. in 1918 in the First Class with honours in philosophy... Arriving in London on 20 October 1919"
- **Version B (B.A. in 1919; arrived in Britain 25 October 1919):** *Encyclopædia Britannica* and *South Asian Britain* state he graduated in 1919, with *South Asian Britain* listing his arrival in Britain as 25 October 1919 | South Asian Britain | > "He joined Scottish Church College and graduated in 1919 with a degree in philosophy." and > "Date of arrival to Britain: 25 October 1919"
- **Version C (Entered Cambridge 9 September 1919):** Singapore's National Library Board lists 9 September 1919 as the date he entered Cambridge | National Library Board Singapore | > "However, he was accepted in Scottish Church College, Calcutta in 1917,

graduating with first class honours in philosophy in 1919. He entered Cambridge University on 9 September 1919"

6. Size of the Free India Legion in Germany and the INA in Southeast Asia

- **Free India Legion size (3,000 vs. 4,000 vs. 4,500):** Sources give different numbers for the Indian prisoners of war trained in Germany: 3,000 (Wikipedia lead), 4,000 (Major N. G. Swami in *Hindustan Times*), or 4,500 (Wikipedia body text) | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "A 3,000-strong Free India Legion was recruited from among Indian POWs" and > "created the Indian Legion (consisting of some 4500 soldiers)" | Hindustan Times | > "In all about 4,000 Indians were in training there."
- **Indian National Army size (40,000 vs. 43,000 vs. 50,000):** Because INA records were burned before the fall of Rangoon in 1945, historians estimate total INA troop strength at around 40,000, 43,000, or 50,000 | Wikipedia: Indian National Army | > "The exact organisation of the INA and its precise troop strength is not known, since its records were destroyed by the withdrawing Azad Hind Government before Rangoon was recaptured"

7. Marriage to Emilie Schenkl

- **Wife vs. companion:** *Encyclopædia Britannica* states Bose and Emilie Schenkl married in 1937, while Wikipedia notes historians describe her either as his wife (married in a secret 1937 ceremony) or companion | Wikipedia: Subhas Chandra Bose | > "During this time, Bose became a father; his wife, or companion, Emilie Schenkl, gave birth to a baby girl."

5. Pictures

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1. **Bose as Commander of the Congress Volunteer Corps (1928):** File:Subhas C. Bose 001.jpg | Shows Subhas Chandra Bose in military-style uniform as General Officer Commanding the Congress Volunteer Corps in Calcutta alongside Motilal Nehru | **Date:** 29 December 1928 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright" and "in the public domain in the United States").
2. **Portrait of Subhas Chandra Bose (1930s):** File:Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose.jpg | Head-and-shoulders studio portrait of Subhas Chandra Bose wearing spectacles and a Gandhi cap | **Date:** 1930s | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").
3. **Subhas Chandra Bose and his brother Sarat Chandra Bose (1937):** File:Subhas Chandra Bose and Sarat Chandra Bose in 1937.jpg | Photograph of Subhas Chandra Bose and his elder brother Sarat Chandra Bose in 1937, displayed at the Netaji Museum in Giddha Pahar, Darjeeling | **Date:** 1937 (photographed at museum 27 November 2020) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").
4. **Mahatma Gandhi and Subhas Chandra Bose at Haripura Congress (1938):**

File:Gandhi and Subhas Bose.jpg | Photograph of Mahatma Gandhi and Congress President Subhas Chandra Bose seated together at the Haripura Congress session | **Date:** 1938 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").

5. **Signature of Subhas Chandra Bose (1938):** File:Subhas Chandra Bose Signature.svg | Document graphic showing the handwritten English signature of Subhas Chandra Bose | **Date:** 2 October 1938 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").
6. **Signed Portrait of Subhas Chandra Bose (1940):** File:Subhas Chandra Bose.jpg | Portrait photograph of Subhas Chandra Bose signed by him on 12 January 1940 | **Date:** Signed 12 January 1940 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India" and "in the public domain in the United States").
7. **The Wanderer W24 Car Used in the 1941 Escape:** File:Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose's Car's Front View.jpg | Front view of the Wanderer W24 sedan preserved at Netaji Bhawan in Kolkata, used by Bose to escape house arrest in January 1941 | **Date:** 21 April 2019 | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Unported (CC BY-SA 3.0).
8. **Subhas Chandra Bose in Germany (c. 1930–1945):** File:Subhas Chandra Bose in Germany (2).jpg | Photograph of Subhas Chandra Bose seated with colleagues in Germany | **Date:** Between 1930 and 1945 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain / Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0 ("This file has been identified as being free of known restrictions under copyright law").
9. **Subhas Chandra Bose Meeting Adolf Hitler (1942):** File:Subhas Chandra Bose meeting Adolf Hitler.jpg | Historical photograph of Bose shaking hands with Adolf Hitler in East Prussia with interpreter Paul Schmidt | **Date:** 27 May 1942 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This image (or other media file) is in the public domain because its copyright has expired and its author is anonymous").
10. **Unissued Azad Hind Postage Stamps Prepared in Berlin (1943):** File:Stamps Azad Hind Smlssu per.jpg | Nine prepared but unissued Azad Hind stamps printed in Germany in 1943, including designs for Continental India and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands | **Date:** 1943 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain (official work under German copyright law, § 5 Abs. 2 UrhG) and Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Unported (CC BY-SA 3.0).
11. **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and Officers of the Azad Hind Fauj (1940s):** File:Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and Members of the Azad Hind Fauj.jpg | Group photograph of Bose in uniform standing with senior INA officers including Lakshmi Sahgal, Shah Nawaz Khan, P. K. Sahgal, G. S. Dhillon, and Abid Hasan | **Date:** 1940 (1940s) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").
12. **Jawaharlal Nehru with Sarat Chandra Bose and Subhas Chandra Bose:** File:Jawaharlal Nehru with Sarat Chandra Bose and Subhas Chandra Bose.jpg | Archival photograph showing Jawaharlal Nehru seated beside Sarat Chandra Bose and Subhas

Chandra Bose | **Date:** Before the 1950s | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").

13. **Declassified Government File from the Netaji Papers (1969):** File:Netaji Papers MEA C-551-6-69-JP.pdf | 50-page scanned Ministry of External Affairs archival file (C/551/6/69/JP) from the declassified Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose papers at the National Archives of India | **Date:** 1969 (declassified from December 2015) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain and Creative Commons CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication.

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